

OREGON CITY COURIER

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TOO MANY LAWYERS

The fact that the Oregon legislature is made up with too many lawyers in the ranks is responsible for a considerable amount of freak legislation that disgraces our statute books, and there doesn't seem to be any way to correct the defect unless the voters realize that business brains are as able if not better able to enact business-like laws than are legal brains. If we had more common business sense in our legislature we would have less trouble with it. The theoretical lawyer, devoid of knowledge of other elements, is a poor excuse as a legislator.

At Salem this year we have a gathering of legislators too large to be controlled or even influenced by the business men who have gained seats in either house. These lawyers are attempting to favor their constituents with talk of economy and they have no more idea how to effect that economy in a business way than they have about flying to Mars in a cat boat.

A lawyer here and there proposes to abolish this and that—he seldom stops to consider the fallacy of his actions and thinks only that he may bring about a saving that may result in his re-election. He doesn't figure in business terms and his legal knowledge is not broad enough to permit him to exercise a business man's intelligence.

Just for instance, wouldn't Clackamas county be a sorry spectacle if the offices of recorder and assessor were abolished to effect the saving that some fool lawyer had been dreaming about? This would be accomplished by measures fathered by lawyers at Salem. The work of both offices would be piled onto the county clerk with no thought of consequences. The fact that the recorder's office is self-supporting, returning money to the county treasury every year, does not enter into the calculations of these legal lights who represent us. The lawyers do not seem to know that assessment work would cost as much money under the clerk as it does at present.

Why do not some of these economy cranks, in the brilliancy of their legal learning, see the places in the county court house where economy might be practiced? It would be possible to make the sheriff's office, for example, entirely self-supporting if we were represented by competent business men.

When Mary Jones and Martha Doe have a back-alley battle of words Mr. Brown and Mr. Smith help to pay the bill. By making Mary and Martha alone responsible for bringing themselves to the bar of justice, through the re-establishment of the fee system in the sheriff's office, the burden of cost in connection with the office would shift from the taxpayers to the lawbreakers. Given business men in the legislature we might have such legislation—but not so long as lawyers are predominant.

THE FARMER ABSOLVED

While we are stretching our energies and imaginations to keep that grim tormentor, the high cost of living, from tromping us under a heavy foot, the national grange comes forward with a clever proclamation in which the farmer is absolutely freed from any taint of suspicion in connection with the rapidly soaring values of life's necessities.

There is little thought that the farmer is responsible for the flight of food, but it is interesting to note that through his important spokesman, the grange headquarters, he is upholding the cost of living. The farmer has been blamed for almost everything and it is quite natural, no doubt, since he is the producer, to ac-

cuse him of having his toll-worn mitt in the high cost of living.

It might be a fact, of course, that the cost of living would be less if the farmer would refuse to accept \$2.00 for a hundred pounds of potatoes or \$1.50 for a bushel of wheat, but that is only a possibility. The farmer, in the first place, is not going to refuse such prices, because it is only once in a score of years that he has a chance to keep any of the pork.

If the farmer refused \$2.00 for his potatoes the consumer would undoubtedly pay just as much for them anyhow, so the farmer had better stay on the safe side and take as much as he can get. The fellows between the farmer and the dinner table are the ones who make the financial haul and it would be a pity to make their share any greater than it already is.

But, the grange proclamation. In directing suspicion in other directions in order to relieve the farmer from the burden, the national grange gives the following reasons for the increased and increasing cost of living. Some of the reasons are good and some are a bit too far-fetched to be real:

Climatic conditions, resulting in crop shortage.

Increased cost of farm labor, machinery and equipment.

Expensive methods of distribution employed by middlemen.

Gambling in food products, especially those in storage.

Alarming increase of insect and fungous pests.

Lack of market facilities in some towns and cities.

A heavy increase in the taxation of farm lands.

COMING ROAD NEEDS

No doubt the time will come when Oregon will have a magnificent system of state highways that will put every section of the state in prompt and easy touch with every other section. The movement is already under way and there is not the slightest doubt in the world that it will spread. The automobile is altering modes of travel, and road systems will have to be altered to fit the new demands that have arisen because of the automobile.

But let no one think for a moment that the state road question is the only important one, warns the Eugene Register. The really vital road problem is putting the outlying country in close and easy touch with market centers, and this problem must be met by the counties. The state roads will fit in with the system of market highways that will sooner or later grow up, but they will make up only a comparatively small portion of the system. For example, the Pacific highway will serve the market needs of the people living on it or near it, but other roads must be provided for those living elsewhere.

The counties of Oregon need to realize first of all the importance of a system of market roads that will reach into all the outlying districts and connect them up with market centers. These roads ought to receive special attention, for once the principal market roads are put in good condition it will be an easy matter to get local help on the side roads.

Then, when these market roads are built, the principle of maintenance must be given consideration, for if they are not maintained they will soon go to ruin—just as all our good roads have been going to ruin in the past. If a road is to remain good, it must be repaired when repairs are needed and not years afterward when it has reverted to a streak of mud between two fences.

The paved road is too costly as yet, and probably will be too costly for a good many years to come for any save the most heavily traveled highways,

but pavement is not necessary in order to have good roads. A good grade, well surfaced with rock or gravel and maintained as it ought to be will give splendid service at reasonable cost. But it must be maintained. It is left untouched it will soon go to wreck.

ANENT DIVORCES

A woman sued for divorce at Oregon City on the ground that her husband would not talk to her. This was a grave error on his part. He may be a man of silence for all we know, but he should have talked to his wife. It might have been an impossible feat for him to talk with her for any great length of time, but he should have said something once in a while to break the monotony.

It may be that she did not talk to him, either, not having the encouragement from him to do so, and that would prove a burden to some women. We wonder if there are any children in that household? That would make quite a difference, the prattle of the youngsters making up for the lack of words on the part of the man, and in that event he would probably not be tongue-tied when at home.

We know of one instance where a husband lived in the same house with his wife and did not exchange words with her for eighteen years. If he had anything to communicate to her he would speak to his two daughters and they would pass on the information to their mother. The man was wealthy, built a church and endowed it, posing as a Christian. This silence started over a trifle and ended only when his death came. This was a Pennsylvania incident. In Oregon eighteen years are not supposed to elapse; the man talks or the woman gets her freedom. Probably it would have been a little less hell on earth if the Pennsylvania woman had done as the Oregon woman is doing, yet in olden days divorces were not so much the fashion as they are now.—Woodburn Independent.

LIVE AND LET LIVE

New Generations Should Branch Out to Create New Fields

Clackamas, Ore., Jan. 25, 1917.

To the editor:

Wealth and homes have to be created. Some people think that wealth comes from God. Now let us look at the real truth of things. Nature holds a bountiful store of things in the raw state. And it takes the work of mind or brain or thought and at the same time the physical part of both men and women to work these raw materials up into necessities of life.

A woman knows what is most needed to create a home and a man works to create those things that are necessary to life. Every state and every county in a state have those raw materials, and as the place begins to be over populated it is best for the young folks to branch out and create new places, new towns, new homes, new factories, new stores and new shops. As a new section of country opens up it is wisdom for young folks to move into new sections and help create new homes and new industries and new business, and at the same time try to live and let live. This idea of whipping folks out of their homes and business to get the same for some one else is on the old robber plan when man was in an uncivilized state. The higher law is to develop a new country, build new homes, start new industries in new places and in unsettled parts of counties and states.

This old United States is big enough and rich enough in nature to give each and all a home if he will only use his brain, his muscle and an abundance of common sense.

Don't try to whip some man out of his business. But be an intelligent man yourself and create a new business in a new place. Work over the raw material into the necessities of life. You can live and let live. You will develop into intelligent self-supporting beings and be men and women as God intended you to be.

MRS. VIOLA BURR

MEMORIAL PROPOSED

Would Have Monument at Waverly Club in Honor of Luelling

On the grounds now occupied by the Waverly Country club, in Clackamas county, was planted Oregon's first orchard.

"That was many years ago," says Hugh Hume in the Portland Spectator, "when Henderson Luelling brought from Indiana in the bed of his oxen-propelled prairie schooner the tender shoots from which have grown an industry that produces something like ten or eleven million dollars to the state.

"It has been suggested by A. L. Mills, George H. Himes and others that on the site of our first orchard should be erected a memorial to the man who planted it. Mr. Himes says the orchardists of the state would readily subscribe to a fund for this purpose; and Mr. Mills knows that the members of the club whose grounds embrace the old Luelling orchard would gladly do the same. But I do not think that the directors of the Waverly Country club would care to have erected by public subscription a monument on the club's grounds. It is likely, therefore, that whatever memorial is raised on the site of Oregon's original orchard in honor of the man who brought to the state and planted the first fruit trees here will have to be erected by the Waverly Country club. No doubt, the new board of directors of the club will be glad to consider the matter.

"Portland has so few beautiful monuments that the opportunity to erect one should be eagerly seized by an organization that represents what is best in the social and business life of the community."

R. L. Holman, Leading Undertaker, Fifth and Main St.; Telephones: Pacific 415-J; Home B-18.

25c Per Month is the Average Cost of Operating a Mitchell Water System

Don't Envy the City Man's Home Make Him Envy Yours!

The city man envies the ruralite for his pure air, his elbow room and his broad gauge life in general but he pities him for one thing—His Water Supply. A few years ago and this pity was well founded, but now the shoe is on the other foot.

THE Mitchell Water System

The MITCHELL SYSTEM enables you

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The Mitchell Water System supplies you with unlimited dependable supply of pure cool water at no more cost (usually not as much) per month than is paid by the average city man for his restricted supply. This is not so of other water systems, which often are a source of great deal more trouble than satisfaction owing to improper construction or poor installation. We have installed hundreds of Mitchell Systems in all parts of the Northwest—they are giving satisfaction to every buyer. We, if given the opportunity, will gladly give you the benefit of our six years' experience in the pneumatic water supply line. We will plan for your home a Mitchell System that will exactly fit your requirements—that will give you service which will please you now and continue to do so for years and years—that's our policy—COMPLETE AND PERMANENT SATISFACTION TO EVERY BUYER—and we have the goods that uphold every claim we make for them. Write us today for our free book on country and suburban water supply systems. Ask for book.

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MR. REYNOLDS of Clackamas, Oregon, has a MITCHELL SYSTEM.



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HOME TALENT EVENING

Band and Athletic Club Combine to Produce Entertainment

For the benefit of the Oregon City band and the Athletic association, a home talent entertainment is to be held in Shively's opera house on Thursday and Friday evenings, February 8 and 9. The plans for the program as outlined at this time provide many unique features and a most interesting arrangement. The band will take part in the entertainment and the high school girls' quartet will appear. Both organizations are practicing for the program.

Among the features of the program will be the appearance of Charles Graham in a new Scotch monologue skit, Mr. Theroux with musical numbers and a one-act play, "A Happy Pair," enacted by Louise Walker and Harry G. Smith. Both Miss Walker and Mr. Smith have had dramatic experience, the latter having received professional training as a member of a college dramatic society.

SCOT ASKS DIVORCE

Henpecked Dan McLaren Married 40 Years. Father of Nine

Married 40 years and parents of nine grown children, Daniel and Agnes McLaren are in Judge Campbell's court here seeking a divorce. The couple was married at Dalry, Scotland, in 1877, and moved to Pennsylvania in 1893. In his complaint Dan McLaren charges his wife with an ungovernable temper and alleges that she has "nagged and henpecked" him during their life in America. Shortly after settling in Pennsylvania Mr. McLaren says he was forced to come to Oregon to escape his wife's temper and from this state he sent money for her support until 1911. In that year he returned east in an attempt to effect a reconciliation, hoping that his wife had mended her ways, a hope which he says kept him from filing divorce proceedings long ago. He was greeted with an outburst of wrath and had to return to Oregon.

LEIGHTON ATTACKED

Mr. Parker Says West Linn Councilman Has Usurped Office

The position of E. A. Leighton, city councilman at West Linn, hangs in the balance as a result of the suit started Tuesday by Eli Parker to oust Leighton from the office. Mr. Parker alleges that Mr. Leighton "usurped, intruded and unlawfully holds" the councilmanic job and brings to light a clause in the city charter of West Linn specifying that a councilman can serve only two successive terms. Mr. Leighton has already served the two terms allotted him and has now entered upon the third term, the complaint charges.

It is understood that the suit is especially important from the fact that Recorder L. L. Porter and another councilman have served two terms and are entering upon the third, in violation of the city charter of West Linn.

20 PUPILS PASS

With highly creditable averages in their various subjects, 20 pupils in the schools of the county where a mid-year class is graduated, have completed their final examinations. The names have been sent to the office of the state superintendent of public instruction by County Superintendent Calavan. They are as follows:

Katherine Wilson, Ione Hagerman, Leonora Mulder, Bina Krogh, Ophelia Goff, Henry Stevens, Milwaukie, No. 1; Millen Kneeland, Clackamas; Oliver Marshall, Hoff; Henry Atwater, Cecil Neibusch, Otto Erickson, Oswego; Alexander Eliason, Edward Peterson, Mr. Angel, Gerald Babcock, Hoff; Kenneth Rayot, Maxwell L. Keiser, Mildred Lynch, Vera Deery, Milwaukie, No. 123; Lucile Baird, Newberg, No. 306; Leonard Harper, Newberg, No. 309.

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Price per 50 Gallon Barrel - - - \$8.50

An additional charge of \$1.00 is made for the barrel, which will be refunded when the barrel is returned.

Price per 5 Gallon Can - - - \$1.25

Price per 1 Gallon Can - - - 25c

An additional price of 10 cents is made for the can, which will be refunded when the can is returned.

26-inch Peerless Hog Fence

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The stiff stays of the Peerless fence make it superior for turning hogs, because they cannot root under it or lift it up. When properly stretched will do effective service for a lifetime.

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300 candle power
No wicks to trim
No danger

The AIR-O-LITE Gasoline Vapor Lamp is guaranteed absolutely safe and is very economical. It uses gasoline and gives a powerful, white, steady, yet mellow light, of approximately 300 candle power, which is over ten times the light given by the ordinary lamp. The light is the same as the natural light of the sun and easy on the eyes. It will run 65 to 80 hours on one gallon of gasoline and thus burns four hours at the cost of only one cent.

It has no odor, no smoke, no wicks to trim, easy to light, and while burning it can be carried around safely in any position. It can even be rolled around on the floor while lit and is perfectly safe. It uses two strong mantels, has no chimney to break and there is no danger of accidents. If you remove the cap to fill it the light goes out. Drafts do not affect it. It's a wonderful reading lamp. The fount is made of 18-gauge strong brass and holds 2 quarts of gasoline. It is tested at a pressure of 200 pounds and absolutely safe. Can be used as a hanging or table lamp. Neat in appearance and furnished complete with plain opal shade. Shipping weight 25 pounds.



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